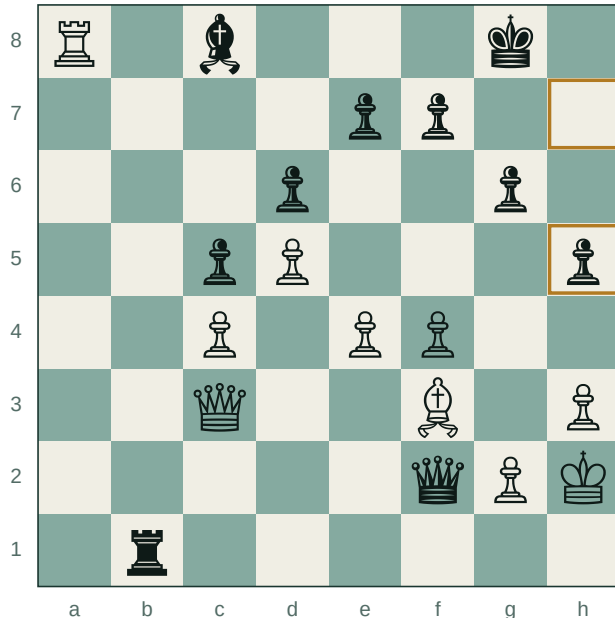


# Loose-piece tactics: White, move 28

Loose-piece tactics

White to move



Previous move: 27...h5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**28. Rxc8+ Kh7 29. Qh8#**

**28.Rxc8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **28...Kh7**.

**29.Qh8#** Mate: queen on h8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A piece may appear hanging because its defender is indirect: taking it might allow mate, a fork, or a stronger capture.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An undefended or tactically undefendable piece can turn an ordinary position into a combination. The first task is to distinguish a truly free capture from a poisoned one.

**HOW TO LOOK**

List the loose enemy pieces and check whether a forcing move can expose or attack more than one of them.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: bishop on c8.